

One Call Away

By Jae Hong Lee
For Isolated Elders



SEED OF IDEAS

AGING SOCIETY

Currently about 17.3%
(58 million) people in United
States are aged over 65+

LIFE EXPECTANCY

From 1993 to 2023, the
expected lifespan has
increased from 75.65 to
79.11 years



The birth rate has
decreased from 15.451 to
12.023 per 1000 people

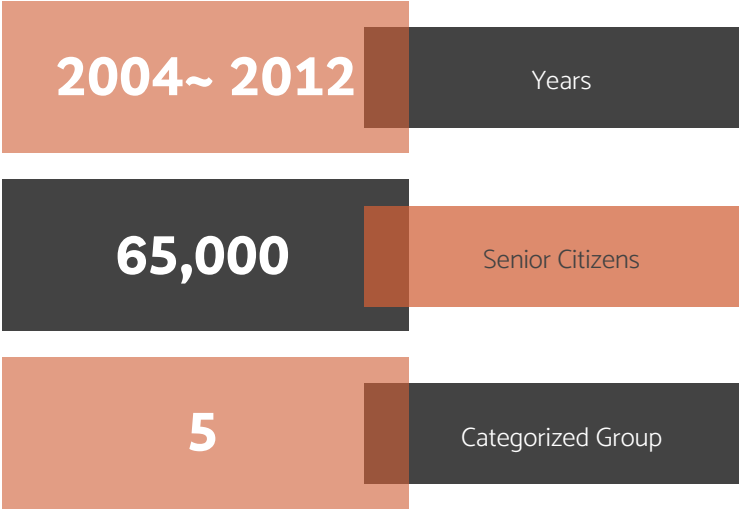
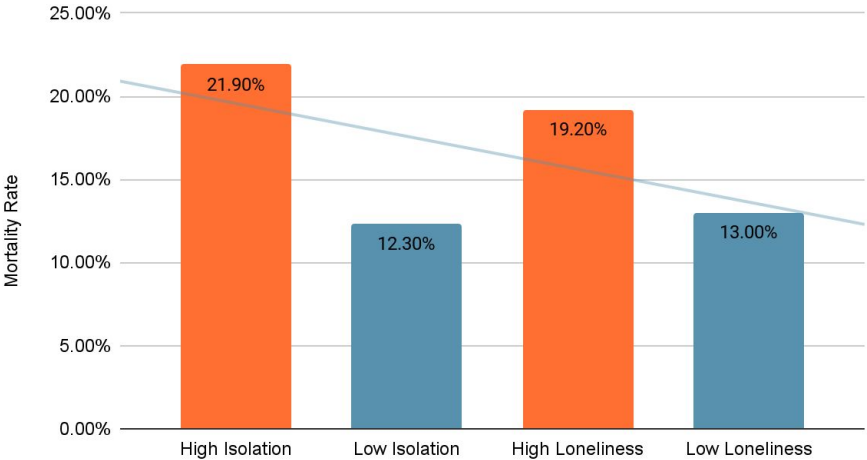
BIRTH RATE

more than a third of adults
over 45 feel lonely, and a
quarter of adults over 65 are
socially isolated

SOCIAL ISOLATION

BACKGROUND

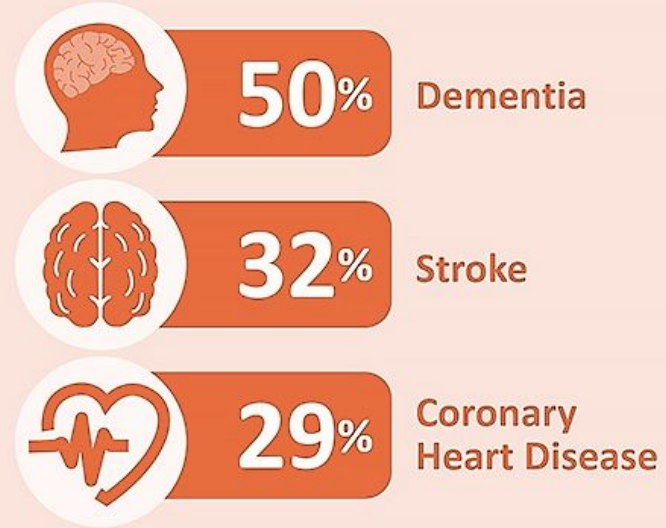
Mortality Rate



BACKGROUND

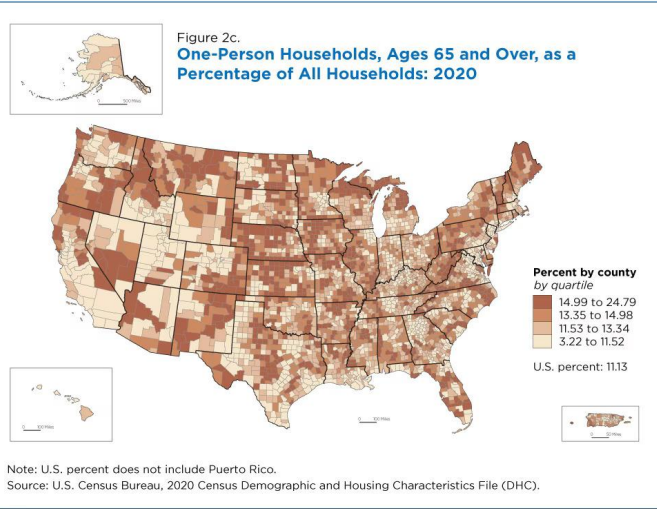
- High blood pressure
- Obesity
- Weakened immune function
- Anxiety
- Depression
- Cognitive decline

**Social isolation
increases the risk of:**



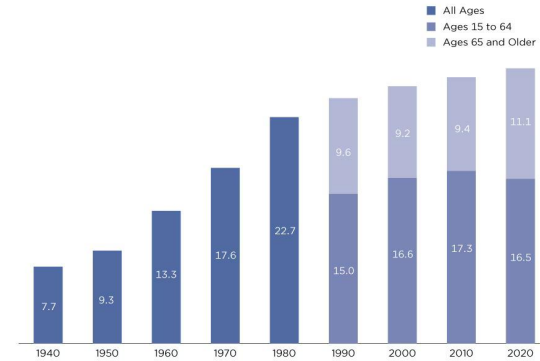
How can we alleviate the loneliness of senior citizens?

ONE-PERSON HOUSEHOLDS



The United States Census Bureau

Figure 1.
One-Person Households as a Percentage of All U.S. Households: 1940-2020

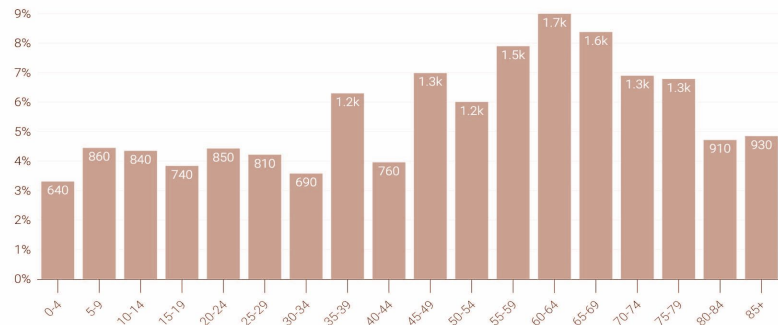


Note: Alaska and Hawaii are not included in the U.S. totals for 1940 and 1950.
Source: U.S. Census Bureau, 1940-1990 Censuses; 2000 Census Summary File 2; 2010 Census Summary File 1; 2020 Decennial Census Demographic and Housing Characteristics File (DHC).

TARGET AUDIENCE

Seminole, FL population by age group

The largest age group is 60-64 years with a population of 1,731 (9.0%)



Seminole Demographic

Studies indicate that there are around 5 million older adults disengaged from community life, battling loneliness and depression.

Sanford, Florida

Senior welfare is particularly urgent in Orange, Seminole, Osceola, and Brevard counties



One Call Away Project

Create a letter-writing friendship program connecting isolated seniors with local residents in Sanford Downtown, Seminole County, Florida.

01 Reaching out Isolated elders through organization such as AARP (American Association of retired persons) or Senior Resource Alliance

02 Record the elders' stories and install them on telephones so that citizens can access them.

03 After listening to the story, people can write letters to communicate.

04 To protect personal information, all letters are sent to the mail hub, and from the hub, mails are sent to each person.

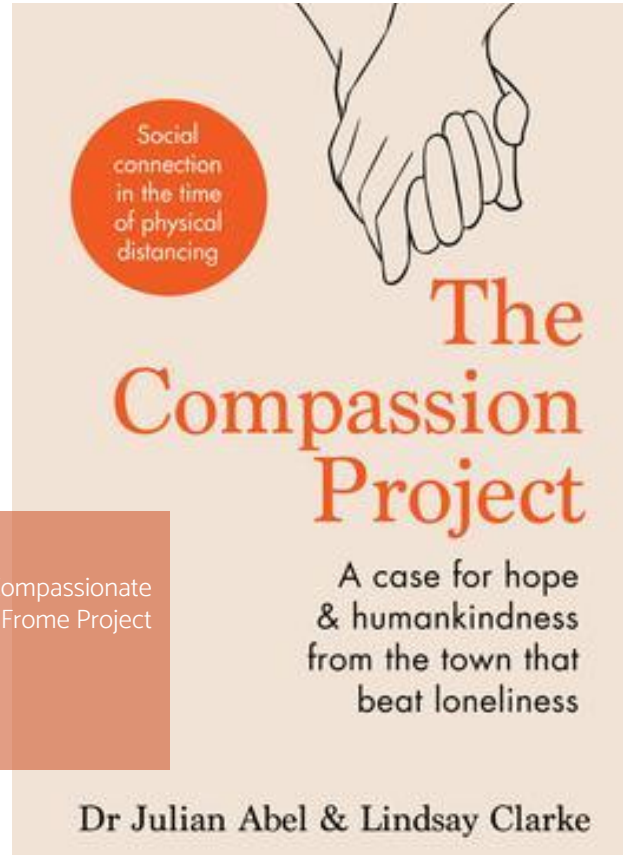


INSPIRING MODELS

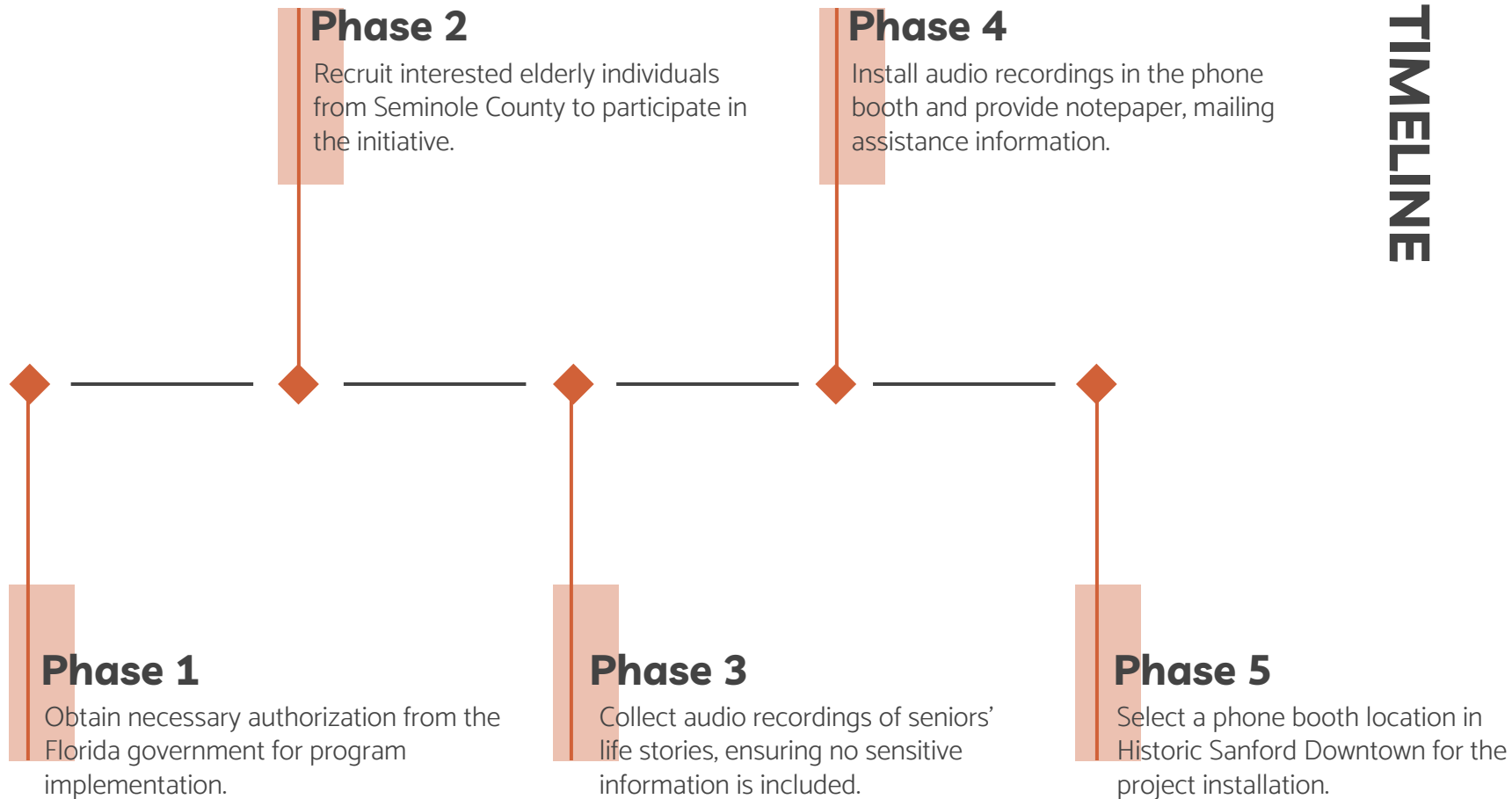


Social Bridging
Projects

Compassionate
Frome Project



TIMELINE



Design Overview

Social Isolation Phone Booth

- Recorded Voice Phone
- One Call Away Project Instruction
- Letter and stationary
- Mail Hub Address Information

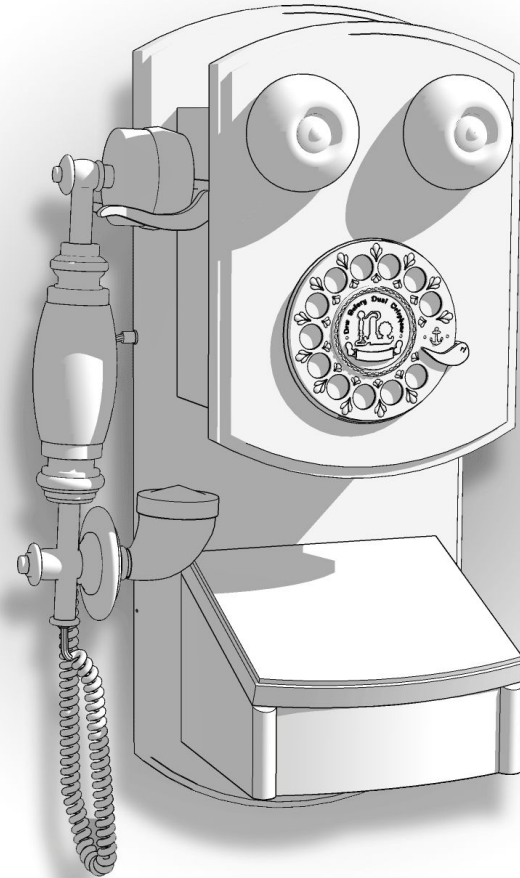
PostBox

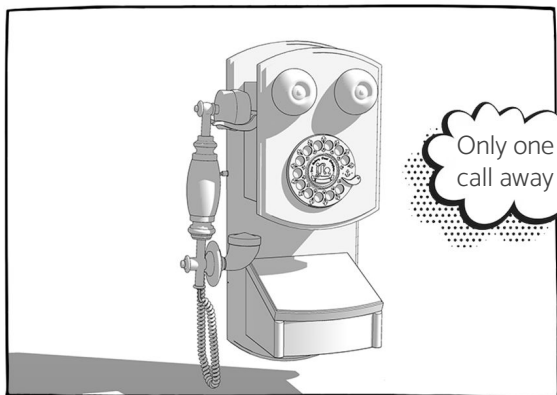
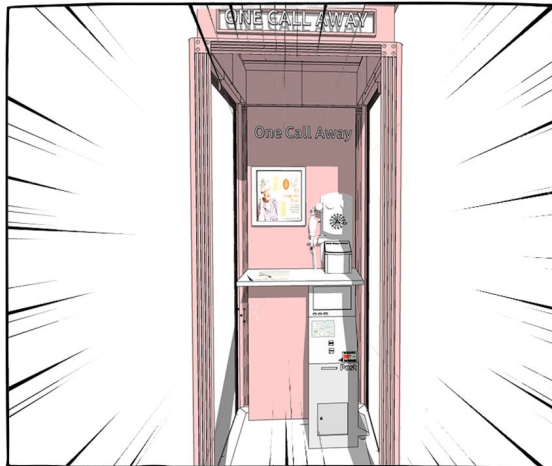
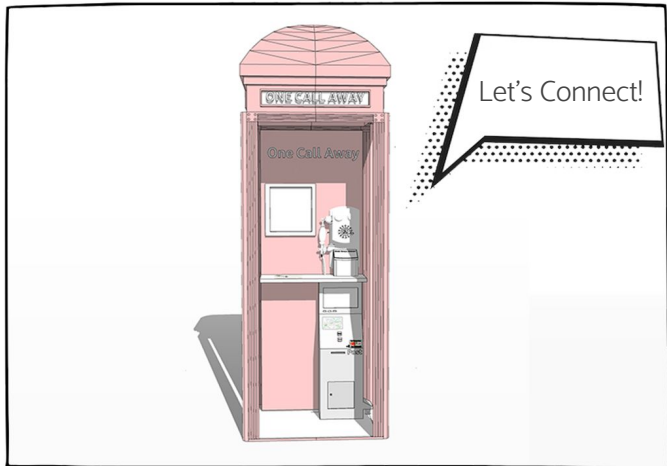
- To send letters after write them

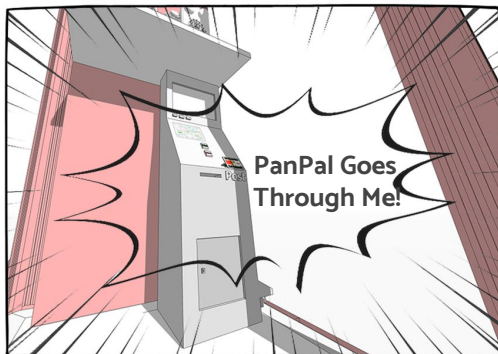


Interview Sample

- ❖ Name, age, family relations (Do you have any brothers or sisters? Do you have any sons or daughters?)
- ❖ Where did you grow up?
- ❖ Stories of past recollections
- ❖ The first job you ever did
- ❖ Childhood dreams
- ❖ Interests and hobbies
- ❖ Emotional and impactful life events







Evaluation Criteria

Participation

- How many elderly individuals have participated?
- How many people have participated in pen-pal activities?
- The frequency of letters exchanged between pen-pal pairs

Relationship formation

- How much has loneliness and emotional distress due to social isolation been relieved after letter exchanges?
- Have elderly and public members engaged in broader social participation activities beyond letter writing?

Project Feedback

- Will the elderly continue to participate in the project in the future?
- Feedback from citizen participants
- Would you consider sending letters again?
- Frequency of accidents

WORK CITED

- “U.S. Life Expectancy 1950-2023”, © 2010-2023 Macrotrends LLC,
<https://www.macrotrends.net/countries/USA/united-states/life-expectancy>.
- “U.S. Birth Rate 1950-2023”, © 2010-2023 Macrotrends LLC,
<https://www.macrotrends.net/countries/USA/united-states/birth-rate>.
- Boston Organization Strives to End Social Isolation, Loneliness in Older Adults”, NBC Boston,
<https://www.nbcboston.com/news/local/boston-organization-strives-to-end-social-isolation-loneliness-in-older-adults/2591107/>
- Andrew Steptoe, Aparna Shankar, Panayotes Demakakos, Jane Wardle. “Social isolation, loneliness, and all-cause mortality in older men and women”, Proceedings of the National Academy of Sciences of the United States of America,
<https://www.jstor.org/stable/42590308>
- “Florida is supposed to be retirement heaven, but for many senior citizens it’s a private hell I Commentary”, Orlando Sentinel,
<https://www.prb.org/resources/which-us-states-are-the-oldest/>
- “Spotlight On: The Social Bridging Project”, By Emma Castleberry,
<https://thelaurelofasheville.com/lifestyle/spotlight-on-the-social-bridging-project/>
- “People Over 65 – Left Behind and Left Out”, Community Action Committee,
<https://www.knoxseniors.org/people-over-65-left-behind-and-left-out/#:~:text=Only%2069%25%20of%20people%2065,of%20those%2080%20and%20older.>

WORK CITED

- The Compassionate Frome Project a.k.a. Health Connections Mendip, If lost start from here, <https://www.ifloststarthere.com/home/2020/11/25/the-compassionate-frome-project-aka-health-connections-mendip>

PHOTOS CITED

- Figure 1: Portrait of Elder, <https://cornellsun.com/2019/02/28/social-isolation-among-older-adults-what-role-can-technology-play/>
- Figure 2: Social Isolation increase the risk of, <https://www.cdc.gov/emotional-wellbeing/features/power-of-connection.htm>
- Figure 3 & 4: One-Person Households More Than Tripled from 1940 to 2020, <https://www.census.gov/library/stories/2023/06/more-than-a-quarter-all-households-have-one-person.html#:~:text=The%20overall%20share%20of%20people,16.5%25%20during%20the%20same%20period.>
- Figure 5: Seminole, FL Population by Age, Neilsbergs, <https://www.neilsberg.com/insights/seminole-fl-population-by-age/>
- Figure 6: Downtown Sanford by Steve Martin/Flickr, <https://1000fof.org/county/seminole-county/>
- Figure 8: The Compassionate Frome Project a.k.a. Health Connections Mendip, <https://www.ifloststarthere.com/home/2020/11/25/the-compassionate-frome-project-aka-health-connections-mendip>